087-2473234, 071-9182551
Notices for the Newsletter may be handed in or by email (as an attachment preferably), to frjoecaulfield@gurteensligo.com

Your prayers please: list to 1 Nov.. by date. List of anniversaries, past 15 years, since 2011.

Dariusz Lysiuk 55, of Gdansk region, Poland & Mullaghroe, who died on Sat. 18 Oct. Sympathy to wife Anna, sons Cezary, Damian & Kasper; mother Hendryka, brothers Tomasz & Aleksander; Cezary's wife Magdalena & their 3 children. Darius & Anna had come to Mullaghroe last year, (formerly John Toolan's).

Gillian Kane, of Ballina & Killiney, who died on Wed. 21 Oct.; her mother Teresa, sister to Joseph Lavin, Killaraght. Sympathy to husb. Stephen Rhys Thomas, their family, her 4 sisters, 2 brothers, & to Joseph Lavin & family.

Thomas Connolly, Greyfield, First Anniv 24 Oct.
Linda Burke née Flanagan, of Killaraght & Tubbercurry, 24.10.'24
Margaret Maree née Costello, of Knock & Cuilmore; 24.10.'21
Paddy Mulligan, First Anniv. 26 Oct.
Joe Keaveney of Breedogue & Terenure, Interred - Killaraght Old, 28.10.'24.
Pascal Coyle, Battlefield, First Anniv. 29 Oct.
Elizabeth (Liz) Dwyer née Carty, Boyle, aunt of Liz Flanagan, 29.10.'23
Sr. M. Vianney Mullen, Ballymote, 29.10.'20.
Mary Alice Queenan, Chasefield, 29.10.'15
Maureen Regan, Boyle, mother of Margaret McDonagh, Cloonloo. 29.10.'15
Patrick 'P' Sherlock, Cross, Edmondstown, brother of Mary McGill, 29.10.'14
Thomas Joseph Tommie Kearns, Perth, of Emlaghfad & London, brother of the late Margaret Gallagher, 30.10.'23
Henry McDermottroe, Ballinafad, 31.10.'19 husb. of Kay Drury of Mahanagh.
Beatrice Berreen, Sidcup, Kent; sister of the late Gerry Shryane. 31.10.'15
Finbarr Costello, Booterstown, brother of the late Denis, Killaraght, 31.10.'14
Paul Wynne, Stonepark, 31.10.'10.

30th. Sunday in Ordinary Time

All Masses in Gurteen, Sundays & weekdays, are online at www.churchtv.ie/gurteen & also on radio 106.5 FM The latest Newsletter is available on **www.churchtv.ie/gurteen** also, on Gurteen Parish Facebook & Instagram

St. Patrick's Church, Gurteen

Sun. 11.30 Margaret Maree 24.10.'21, parents John 24.10.'83 & Margaret Costello.
Bridie Coleman 19.10.'21, Pat, sons Tommy, 15.8.'23, Frank, Pat Joe & James; & decd. of the Coleman & Sherlock families.
Tony Casey 14.10.'15 John Flannery & decd of the Casey & Flannery families \16.8.'24
Mon. **11.00** Paddy Mulligan First Anniv. 26 Oct. brothers Joe 6.10.'13, Vinny, & Christine Mulligan 4.7.'25.
Mon. **7.00** Harvest Thanksgiving Mass for all Volunteers: Church, Community, Sports,
Tues. 10.00 Mass. \ Individuals too, who help.
Wed. 10.00 Bridget Mary Conroy 29.10.'82, husb. Elias, sons Kevin, Seán 5.11.'95 & Brendan, his son David, Kevin's wife Doreen,
Thurs.10.00 Mass. \ & decd. of the family.
Fri. 7.00 No Mass. Sat. 10.00 No Mass.
Sun. 11.30 The Community, Living & Deceased.
Adoration of Holy Eucharist Wed. 7 – 8pm
The Rosary is prayed in the last quarter hour.

St. Joseph's Church, Cloonloo

Sat. 7.00 Maureen Lyons née O'Gara, husb. Paddy, John Lavin 3.4.'22 & Liam O'Gara 7.5.'21.
Sat. 7.00 John Francis McDermott 4.11.'22, & sister Christina 25.12.'24.

St. Attracta's Church, Killaraght

Sun. 9.30 The Community, Living & Deceased.
Fri. 10.00 Mass.
Sun. 9.30 Tommy O'Grady 17.10.'05, wife Attracta 19.2.'00, son Gerry 29.4.'03.

Mission Sunday Collection Thank you for your envelopes to support the Churches, clergy, sisters, catechists, in poorer countries, showing your solidarity to them. Envelopes to come, welcome.

Kay McGrath née Killeen of Derryknockeran, & Providence, Rhode Is. 1.11.'23
Liam Allen, London, father of Paul, Knocknaskeagh. 1.11.'23
James Gerard O'Hara, Doon Rock, 1.11.'21

Feastdays: Week 30 Ordinary Time Cycle II
Tues. 27th St Otteran of Iona, patron - Waterford.
Wed. 28th Ss Simon & Jude, Apostles.
Thur. 29th St Colman, bishop Aran/ Kilmacduagh
Sun. 1 Nov. Feast of All Saints.

Cemetery Prayers: on Sunday 01 Nov.
Killaraght New Cemetery - 10.20, after Mass.
Gurteen - 2.15. Mount Irwin - 3.00.
Carrantample - 3.45.

On Sunday 08 Nov. Templeronan 3.00.
Killaraght old Cemetery 2.15.

Remembrance Service on Sun. 22 Nov., at 5pm.

November Masses for the Holy Souls:
November envelopes are at each Church door.
You can put as many names as you wish.
12 Masses will be offered for your deceased.
Please put your envelope into offertory basket.
Or, in Gurteen, box at Blessed Sacrament altar,
or, return to Fr Joe at No. 3 Cois na hAbhann.
A modest offering is sufficient. Thanking you.

Gurteen Cemetery Annual Collection, upkeep, improvements. Donations welcome at gate next Sun. Envelopes may be also returned to Centra, to the Church or to Fr Joe.

Carntample Cemetery & Mount Irwin Annual Collectionfor upkeep & improvements, next Sun.

Gurteen Choir would gladly welcome singers & Musicians. Just over 8 weeks to Christmas, for practices before - Nora O'Connor 086-0859039.

The Irish National Synodal Assembly took place last Sat. 17 Oct. in Gormanston, bringing together nominated lay, clerical & religious delegates. See report on www.theway.ie

Grásta Pre-Marriage courses 13-15 Nov. & 26-28 Feb. 2027. Married Couples Courses 14-15 Nov. & 27-28 Feb. 2027. Course venue: De La Salle Pastoral Centre, Laois R32 N6D8. For information, contact info@grasta.org.

Lotto Gurteen Celtic, Sun. 18th, 10, 11, 22, 25. €50 to Anthony Simpson. J'pot €2600, Mon. 26th

Eastern Harps 50/50 €580; M. + M. McDermott

Bingo each Fri. at 8pm, in the Parish Hall. Jackpot €2,900 in 47 calls, & Lotto J'pot €500.

Harvest Thanksgiving Mass to celebrate all who are involved as volunteers in Church, Community Sports, players on teams, also, home helpers. All involved in the many & various ways, giving of their time & talents for others, thereby creating Community. Not just for Volunteers, all welcome. **Guest speaker Fr. Dan O'Mahony.**
Bank holiday Mon. 26 Oct. 7pm, Gurteen Church One of the few occasions when people from the 3 Church areas come together. Light refreshments in the Hall. Parish Pastoral Council – organising. Members of the choirs of the 3 churches will combine on the evening. At start, representatives will present items, symbols, of various activities & groups in the community. Thank you to members - Gurteen Parish Pastoral Council, who have been meeting many times to organise, make contacts, arrangements, & prepare refreshments: Maria Duignan, Chair, Bernie O'Hara, Sec. Liz Flanagan, Patricia McDonagh, Cathal O'Gara, Jos Cryan, Tom McCormack, Irene McDonagh, Peter Deeley, Fr Joe.

Baptism We welcomed in the Sacrament this Sat. Cúan Coleman Lowry, born 14 Aug., to Kelly (Coleman) & Darragh Lowry, Gurteen View.

Birth Congratulations to Deirdre (Reilly) & John McNulty, for baby Esme Bríd, born 17 Oct., sister to Edie, their home at Cois na hAbhainn.

Atractus Adult All-Female Singing Group, being formed by Victoria Massey 085-2815131. specialising in liturgical & music with a spiritual theme; 2 & 3 part harmonies. Due to storm, the first rehearsal in Killaraght church postponed to next Sat. 4.30. Concert before Christmas.

Carn N.S. fundraising for All-weather Play Area. Rafflet took place in school yesterday for Center Parcs €1500 family voucher. Great excitement & delight. Winners - Joe & Josephine McNulty.

Carn N.S. says a huge 'Thank you' to the school community, families, wider Gurteen community, & the very generous local businesses who have supported this raffle! Raffle raised €12,890 & €7,725 through online donations, in total €20,615 See it all on Facebook.com Carn National School

Mass offerings - a priest may retain one offering (stipend) per day. When there is a second Mass or several Mass intentions, as recently, the 'extra' stipends go to the Retired & Sick Priest's Fund, or to the church fund where Mass was celebrated.

Coping with Grief and Loss - a four-week programme on 'Finding Hope after a Bereavement' in the Newman Centre, Ballina on the Tuesday nights of Nov., 4th, 11th, 18th, 25th from 8-10pm. presented by Monica Morley To book a place tel. the Newman on 096-72066.

Adult Catechism Course Mondays 7.30 to 9pm, with Fr Farrell Cawley, in the Pastoral Centre, Ballymote, to explore the Catechism of the Catholic Church. New participants very welcome.

Anam Cara, the organisation that supports bereaved parents, will hold its monthly Parent Support Evening on Tues. 27 Oct. at 7.30pm in the TF Royal Hotel, Castlebar. This event is free, open to all bereaved parents regardless of the age your child died, the circumstances of their death, or how recent their death was. You do not need to register in advance. Also, an online support group meeting. To find out more 01-4045378 or email info@anamcara.ie

Keash/Culfadda Newsletter
October 25th 2026
Daylight Saving Time ends
Thirtieth Sunday in Ordinary time, Year 2
Year A

Phone: Fr. Gabriel Murphy (086)3429686
Notices for Newsletter email: gmurphy@achonrydiocese.org
Masses from Keash & Culfadda Churches are Live streamed.
For more information visit our website: www.keashparish.ie
Please note that the Webcam will be in operation in the Sanctuary area, and it's surrounds of both Churches within our parish.

St Kevin's Church Keash

Saturday 24th 6.30pm Loretta Henry, Greenane (First Anniversary).
Wednesday 28th 10.00am. People of the parish.
Friday 30th 10.00am.
Vigil Mass of the Feast of All Saints.
Saturday 31st 6.30pm Christy Mullen, late of Dernaskeagh & London, (First Anniversary). Also, Tommy Killoran, Battlefield and the deceased members of the Killoran family.

Our Lady of the Rosary Church Culfadda

Sunday 25th 10.00am Eileen & Kevin O' Connor, Rathmullen (6th Anniversary).
Tuesday 27th 10.00am.
Day Mass of the Feast of All Saints.
Sunday 1st 10.00am Fr Vincent Murphy, also, Alice & Martin Murphy, Knockbrack, Aclare, Co. Sligo.

Readers.

Saturday 24th Mary Dwyer & Mark Henry. **Sunday 25th** Kieran Kielty.
Saturday 31st Padraic Duffy. **Sunday 1st** Sharon Hunt.

Recent Death.

Your prayers are requested for Rena Kielty née Monaghan, Rooskeymore and formerly of Killeen, Granard, Co. Longford. Also, Niamh Flatley née O Brien, Castlehyde House, Fermoy, Co. Cork and formerly of Kilbride, Co. Meath, who died recently in the Beacon Hospital, Dublin (wife of Michael Flatley, whose father was originally from Battlefield).
May their souls rest in peace. Amen.

November Masses for the Holy Souls.

"it is …. a holy and wholesome thought to pray for the dead".
November envelopes are available in both Keash and Culfadda Churches, Please take one and fill in the names of your deceased relatives, friends and neighbours especially those who have no one left to pray for them, so that they can be remembered in the Masses for the Holy Souls which will be said during the month of November.

Cemetery Rosaries.

The rosary will be recited in Templevanny Cemetery on Sunday November 1st at 12 noon.
The rosary will be recited in Knockbrack Cemetery on Sunday November 8th at 12 noon.
The rosary will be recited in Toomour Abbey on Sunday November 15th at 12 noon.

Culfadda Hospice Walk & Darts Night – Update.

A massive THANK YOU to Higgins Darts Team and All who supported our function and auction this year.

To all Helpers Sponsors and everyone who donated, All the Staff in Higgins and everyone who spent their hard earned money. It was a massive Success

WALK RAISED €9,337.50

DARTS NIGHT AND AUCTION RAISED €7,475.00

TOTAL RAISED €16,812.50

Cheque presentation in Higgins Lounge on Sunday 1st November @ 7pm All welcome

Readers' Rota 2027 – An Invitation to Take Part.

A new Readers' Rota for 2027 is currently being prepared, and we warmly invite anyone who would like to become a reader, or who is already involved in this ministry, to let Fr Gabriel know.

We would especially love to welcome our young people and junior readers to this important ministry. Junior readers will be accompanied by an adult reader, with each proclaiming a reading at Mass. They will meet in the sacristy before Mass to prepare together.

We warmly encourage our young people to consider taking up this ministry and playing a more active part in the life of our parish. Guidance, support and training will be provided, and each reader will have their own Missal to help them practise and prepare. No one needs to feel apprehensive about beginning; with preparation and encouragement, confidence will grow.

Bishop Kevin Doran has recommended that readings at Mass be proclaimed from the Lectionary at the ambo. To help ensure that everything runs smoothly, readers are asked to arrive in good time before Mass and check the Lectionary to make sure it is open at the correct page.

Good preparation is essential and helps every reader proclaim the Word of God clearly, reverently and confidently.

To our young people and their parents: we encourage you to consider this wonderful opportunity to become more involved in our parish community. With the support of parents and the wider parish family, our young people can grow in confidence, deepen their faith and discover the joy of sharing God's Word with others.

If you would like to join the Readers' Rota for 2027, please speak to Fr Gabriel.

Everyone is welcome, and every willing heart is valued.

Please Donate Online,

www.keashparish.ie

Thank you for your support.



Sunday 18th October
Mass Intentions.
Tourlestrane church

Sunday 18th October: 10.30am : Annie O'Hara, son Jimmy, grandson John, deceased of O'Hara family. Family Mass
Monday 19th October: No Mass
Tuesday 20th October: 9.30am No Mass
Wednesday 21st October: 9.30am No Mass
Thursday 22nd October: No Mass
Friday 23rd October: 7pm No Mass
Saturday 24th October: No Mass
Sunday 25th October: 10.30am: No Mass

Kilmactigue church

Saturday 17rd October: 7pm : Beatrice Fleming
Sunday 18th October: No Mass
Monday 19th October : 9.30am
Tuesday 20th October: 9.30am Holy Souls
Wednesday 21st October : 9.30am The Carr Family
Thursday 22nd October: 9.30am:
Friday 23rd October : 7pm
Saturday 24th October: 7pm: Peggy, Hughie, and Kieran Leonard
Sunday 25th October: 10.30am Christina Walsh, Rita Walsh Kelly, and Mattie Walsh

Lough Talt church

Sunday 18th October: 9.20am: John Forde
Sunday 25th October: 9.20am: Mary Kate O'Dwd, Mountaffe, all members of O'Dowd family

First reading

Isaiah 45:1,4-6

I have taken Cyrus by his right hand to subdue nations before him

Thus says the Lord to his anointed, to Cyrus,

whom he has taken by his right hand
to subdue nations before him
and strip the loins of kings,
to force gateways before him
that their gates be closed no more:

'It is for the sake of my servant Jacob,
of Israel my chosen one,
that I have called you by your name,
conferring a title though you do not know me.
I am the Lord, unrivalled;
there is no other God besides me.
Though you do not know me, I arm you
that men may know from the rising to the setting of the sun
that, apart from me, all is nothing.'

Responsorial Psalm

Psalm 95(96):1,3-5,7-10

Give the Lord glory and power.

O sing a new song to the Lord,
sing to the Lord all the earth.
Tell among the nations his glory
and his wonders among all the peoples.

Give the Lord glory and power.

The Lord is great and worthy of praise,
to be feared above all gods;
the gods of the heathens are naught.
It was the Lord who made the heavens,

Give the Lord glory and power.

Give the Lord, you families of peoples,
give the Lord glory and power;
give the Lord the glory of his name.
Bring an offering and enter his courts.

Give the Lord glory and power.

Worship the Lord in his temple.
O earth, tremble before him.
Proclaim to the nations: 'God is king.'
He will judge the peoples in fairness.

Give the Lord glory and power.

Second reading

1 Thessalonians 1:1-5

We constantly remember your faith, your love and your hope

From Paul, Silvanus and Timothy, to the Church in Thessalonika which is in God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ; wishing you grace and peace from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

We always mention you in our prayers and thank God for you all, and constantly remember before God our Father how you have shown your faith in action, worked for love and persevered through hope, in our Lord Jesus Christ.

We know, brothers, that God loves you and that you have been chosen, because when we brought the Good News to you, it came to you not only as words, but as power and as the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction.

Gospel Acclamation

Jn17:17

Alleluia, alleluia!
Your word is truth, O Lord:
consecrate us in the truth.
Alleluia!

Gospel

Matthew 22:15-21

Give back to Caesar what belongs to Caesar

The Pharisees went away to work out between them how to trap Jesus in what he said. And they sent their disciples to him, together with the Herodians, to say, 'Master, we know that you are an honest man and teach the way of God in an honest way, and that you are not afraid of anyone, because a man's rank means nothing to you. Tell us your opinion, then. Is it permissible to pay taxes to Caesar or not?' But Jesus was aware of their malice and replied, 'You hypocrites! Why do you set this trap for me? Let me see the money you pay the tax with.' They handed him a denarius, and he said, 'Whose head is this? Whose name?' 'Caesar's' they replied. He then said to them, 'Very well, give back to Caesar what belongs to Caesar – and to God what belongs to God.'

Offertory Collection

The Offertory Collection for weekend 11th October was €1,110.92

Enrolment Mass

The Enrolment Mass for "Growing in Love,". the preparation programme for children making their first Communion takes place this Sunday 18th October at

10.30am in Tourlestrane church. There will be a blessing for any religious articles that you bring to the Mass.

Irish National Synodal Assembly

The *Working Document* for the Irish National Synodal Assembly, taking place in Gormanston, Co Meath, on 17 October, brings together the fruits of five years of prayer, listening and discernment and will guide delegates as they consider and vote on suggested actions to be presented to the bishops of Ireland. While the Assembly marks an important moment in the journey, the Synodal Pathway is now moving towards a new phase of implementation. Everyone is invited to read, pray with, and reflect on the *Working Document* and the question: "What does God want from the Church in Ireland at this time?" Please pray for all those taking part in the Assembly and for the guidance of the Holy Spirit, and scan the QR code to access the Working Document and find out more, and see www.synod.ie

Mission Sunday is this Sunday

Confessions

Confessions is available on Friday evenings in Tourlestrane church at 6pm to 6.30pm in the adoration room.

The Rosary

The Rosary Continues to be prayed in the Lake church every Night for the month of October Monday-Saturday 8:30pm, Sunday 8pm! "All Are Welcome in this Place" in particular we invite parents to bring their children along to experience praying the Rosary! Fr. Peyton once said "the family that prays together. stays together.

Reciting the Rosary

As a result of the Special evening on last Thursday's celebration of Our Lady of Banada, a number of people plan to recite the Rosary before Sunday morning Masses in Tourlestrane church.

Tourlestrane church maintenance

Due to necessary repair work in Tourlestrane church, it will close on Monday 19th October until the work is complete. An extra Mass will be celebrated in Kilmactigue church on the weekend.

Banada Abbey Bingo

Banada Abbey Bingo this Tuesday at 8.00pm. Books can now be purchased online up to 6.00pm on Tuesday. New Jackpot Game for €2,000 now on 47 calls or less.Prize-fund of €10,500 on offer.

Bake Sale

TUBBERCURRY COMMUNITY FIRST RESPONDERS are holding their Annual Fundraising Bake Sale on Saturday 24th October in the pop up shop on Main Street from 10am-1pm. Donations of baked goods are welcome. Funds raised helps the group to purchase essential equipment to respond to emergency

calls and to provide life-saving training within the community. Every donation makes a difference so please come along and support us on the day. Thank you.

Kilmactigue Parish Defibrillator Group

CPR / AED Training Autumn Schedule 2026. Training will take place in the Hillary Room, on: - Thursday 22nd Oct. 7pm - Sunday 1st Nov. 12 noon. Instructors will be in touch with those previously trained. If you have not trained before and would like to do so, please contact 087 473 4896.

Fundraising

We are currently replacing all the outdoor cabinets in which the Defibs are placed because of issues with dampness & temperature control. Because of this, like before, we will be reaching out to the parish community in the new year to form a fundraising committee & help with raising funds to continue this vital programme in our parish. An account of spending since the last fundraiser along with a list of all those trained in CPR AED in our parish will be available towards the end of year. Looking forward to seeing ye all at our training in the coming weeks.

FRC

A free Hearing Health Awareness talk will take place on Thursday 22nd in Tubbercurry FRC from 11am-12.30pm.Talk covers hearing health, hearing aids and technology, grants and financial support, questions and individual ear health checks. Book your place on 0719186926.

Baby bonding course with Tubbercurry **FRC** starting this November 3rd from 10am-11am. Suitable for parents, carers and babies from 28+ weeks of pregnancy to 8 months. €15 for the 6 week block. Contact 0719186926 for more information and bookings.

The Inner Confidence personal development course with a coaching and wellbeing specialist will take place this November in Tubbercurry **FRC**. Build greater self-trust, confidence and emotional resilience. This is a four week programme starting Monday 2nd November & costs €20. Places limited and bookings to 0719186926.

A Family Carers support group will meet in the **FRC** on the third Tuesday of each month starting Tuesday 20th October at 11am supported by Family Carers Ireland . No one should have to care alone. Join Alvina your local support manager at this group, get to know others who are caring, learn about the range of services and supports available from Family Carers Ireland. The sessions will be a safe and welcoming space to share and be heard. For inquiries or further information contact

St Vincent De Paul

The new phone number for the local conference is 0870014236.

Parish Safeguarding Handbook.

The Parish Safeguarding handbook is available on
http://achonrydiocese.org/safeguardinghandbook/

Banada Abbey Hall Autumn Activities

Monday 6pm Insight drama school.
7pm Ladies exercise with Mairead
8pm Men's exercise class
Hall monthly meeting at 9 pm on Hilary room new members welcome

Tuesday 7pm Yoga with Laura
8pm Bingo

Thursday 6pm Pilates and mindfulness for children with Sarah
7pm Pilates with Sarah
8pm Bowls

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Bereavement

The Bereavement Course presented by Monica Morley, Director of the Knock Shrine Family Centre and Broadcaster at Midwest Radio is due to commence Tuesday 3rd November at 8pm here at The Newman Institute. The cost of the course is €60 and will run for the 4 Tuesday nights in November. To book a place please phone 096 72066 or email reception@newman.ie
The Monthly Bereavement Support Group Meetings will commence on 15th October at 8pm and will meet every second Wednesday of each month from October 2026 to May 2027 inclusive.

Cloonacool Players

Watch this space as Cloonacool Players, our stars of comedy, are now in rehearsals and will soon announce their staging of two hilarious farces. Mighty surprises and laughs galore are on the horizon - and yes, before Christmas.

5 Step Support Service

Are you affected by the misuse of alcohol or other drugs by another individual ?
5 Step Support can help you; it is a free , non-judgemental, one - one service.
Putting your needs and wellbeing first , helping you manage often stressful , difficult and emotional issues
If you would like further information or an appointment, please contact
071 9150578 / 085 875 9319 or email sligoleitrim@alcoholforum.com
You don't have to be addicted to suffer from addiction!

Our policy regarding children in our parish churches?

If your kids are loud, please still come to church.

If you're running late because getting everyone out the door was a battle, please still come to church.

If your toddler won't sit still, please still come to church.

If your baby needs to eat, please still come to church.

If your child asks questions at the least convenient time, please still come to church.

If someone cries, drops a toy, needs a snack, or has to make their third trip to the bathroom, please still come to church.

If your child doesn't know all the words, all the prayers, or exactly when to sit and stand, please still come to church

If you feel like you spent the entire mass managing your children and heard approximately 12% of the sermon, please still come to church.

If Sunday morning feels messy instead of peaceful, please still come to church

If you're worried about, if you're worried your children are distracting the people around you, please still come to church.

Because children do not learn how to be part of the church by staying home until they can sit quietly.

They learn by being here.

They learn the singing by hearing us sing.

They learn the prayers by hearing us pray.

They learn to worship by watching us worship.

They learn that church is home because we make room for them here.

The wiggles, whispers, dropped crayons, crying babies, and little voices are not interruptions to the life of the church.

They are evidence that the church is alive.

So bring the babies, bring the toddlers, bring the big kids, come late, sit at the back, sit in the front, step out where you need to. and come right back in.

Just come.